*by these water mafias because she was mapping the water system. There are around 151 unofficial water hydrants and she was killed because of that*' (Focus Group, Private University[23]).

Karachi was also regularly the target of sectarian violence led by anti-Shia groups such as the LeJ. As the violence engulfed Pakistan in 2009, Karachi was left relatively unaffected. Violence levels had been at a historic low since 2004. However, not for long. During the 2009 Rahe Nijad operation, many militants fled South Waziristan following those who had fled Swat and settled in Karachi's many katchi abadis to regroup. In May 2010 after a drive-by shooting marking a turf war between criminal gangs, a curfew was declared and Karachi was back at war. The various militant groups that had fled FATA were now terrorizing the city and at war with the groups that had controlled Karachi previously. Terror in Karachi also took the form of increased kidnappings for ransom to fund the various conflicts raging in the city and in the wider country. Ordinary civilians of all walks of life were being taken for ransom, so that with the money the groups could buy arms. Gangs representing the old ethnic political parties as well as the newly arrived jihadi outfits started to operate like warlords in the areas they controlled.

The deadliest year for Karachi was 2013 with 2,700 casualties, mostly victims of targeted attacks. According to the International Crisis Group 40 per cent of businesses fled the city to avoid growing extortion rackets. Young people were disgusted with the situation and especially with the involvement of politicians and their parties: '*Things are not really as they seem. Sau shaitaan martei hain tu aik siyasat daan banta hai*'[24] (Student, Male, Quetta); '*Target killings are all about money, not religion or ideology. People are paid a sum of money to kill and create chaos*', '*Politicians do it for money Create chaos and then ask foreign countries for money to fight*' (Student, Female, Quetta). The respondents saw the police and army as part of the same apparatus as the leading politicians: '*Same family. It is like in a family there is a head and other members, same case here. The head is the hukamraan that could be the politician. They keep saying "namaaloom afraad" (unknown individuals)*[25] *are responsible. How can they not know? Of course they are also involved in all these killings*' (Student, Male, Quetta).

The state's response to the rising levels of lawlessness in September 2013 was to empower the paramilitary Rangers to operate against the criminal gangs and jihadi networks across the city. The clashes had resulted in extrajudicial killings, torture and enforced disappearances reinforcing ethnic tensions. In 2015, the Ismaili community was targeted by Jundullah, a group that broke away from